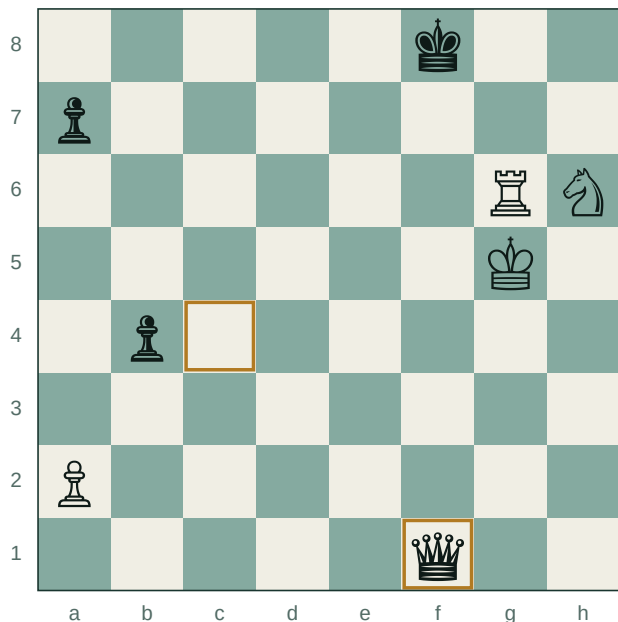


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 55

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 54...Qf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

55. Rf6+ Qxf6+ 56. Kxf6 a5 57. Nf5 b3 58. axb3

55.Rf6+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on f8 and queen on f1. Recorded reply: **55...Qxf6+**.

56.Kxf6 The king captures the queen on f6. Recorded reply: **56...a5**.

57.Nf5 The knight moves from h6 to f5. Recorded reply: **57...b3**.

58.axb3 The pawn captures the pawn on b3.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: queen on f1. Check for tactical protection.